

Post-incident review PIR-2025-022

Identity Platform: intermittent timeouts

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 10 February 2025, Identity Platform experienced intermittent timeouts in production (AU East) for about 240 minutes. The end-to-end checkout probe went red. Investigation found that a certificate on the internal API gateway lapsed over a weekend.

Impact

Users of Identity Platform saw intermittent timeouts for about 240 minutes. The service owner, Identity and Access, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:19 First signal received.
- 09:30 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:52 Likely cause identified.
- 10:30 Mitigation applied.
- 10:35 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a certificate on the internal API gateway lapsed over a weekend.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

The rollback script had never been exercised and failed on first use.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.